ZAKKYBOY 313

# Install guide

How to put games on your ZakkyBoy

## What you need

- **Your ZakkyBoy.**
- **A USB-C data cable.** Some cables only charge; if nothing shows up later, try a different one.
- **A Windows PC or Mac with Google Chrome or Microsoft Edge.** Safari, phones and iPads can't do this.

You don't need to install any software or make an account.

## Installing a game

1 **Open the games page in Chrome or Edge:** `zakkyboy313.github.io/zakkyboy-games`

2 **Plug your ZakkyBoy into the computer** with the USB-C data cable.

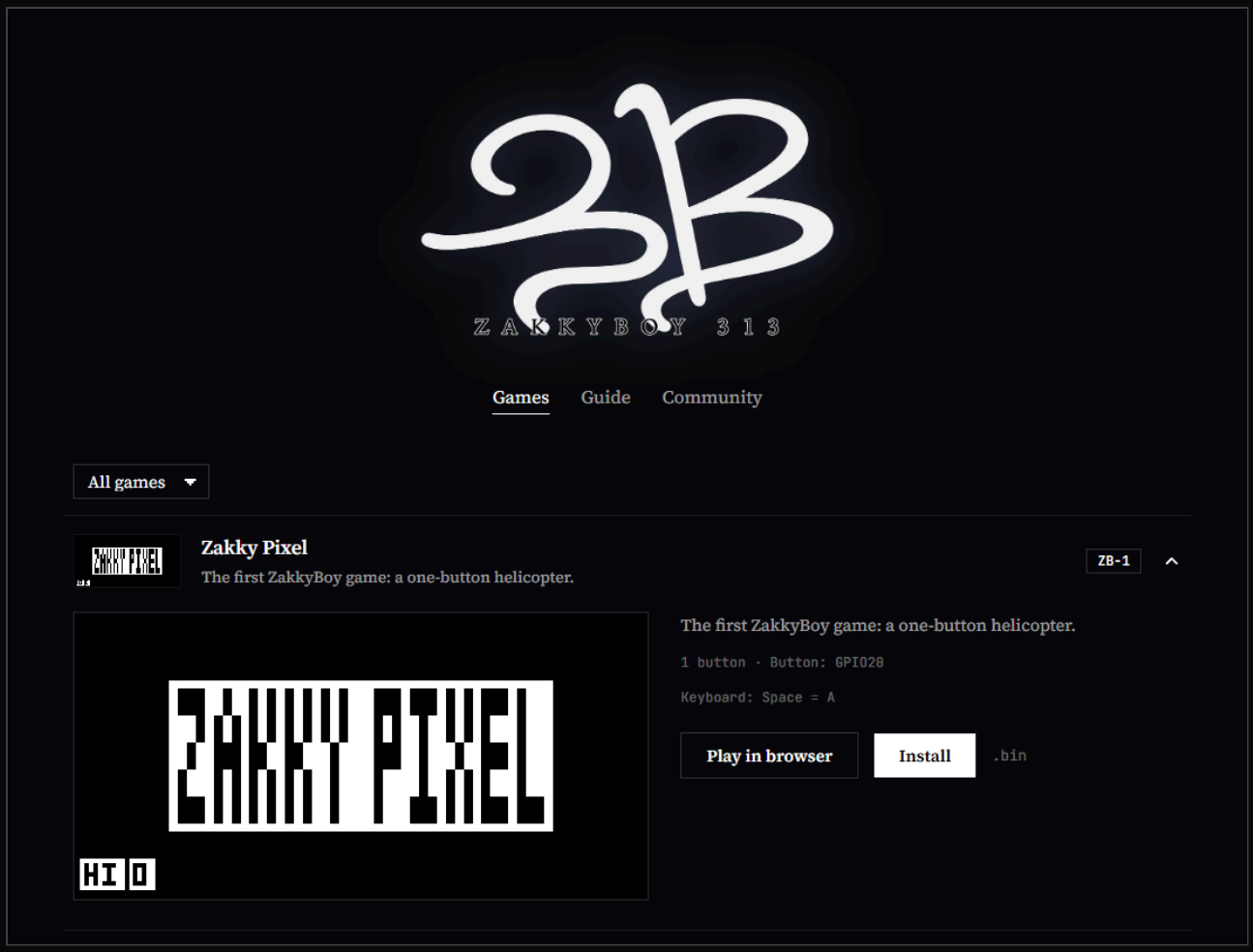
3 **Pick a game.** Use the **All games** box to show only games for your number of buttons (a ZB-1 has one), then click a game to open it.

4 **Click Install**, choose your ZakkyBoy from the pop-up list, then **Connect**. It's usually called *USB JTAG/serial debug unit*.

5 **Click Install again.** It asks whether to erase the device first. You can leave this unticked (ticking it also wipes high scores).

6 **Wait for "Installation complete"** (20 to 40 seconds), then press reset or unplug. The game starts by itself.

## The games page




Click a game to open it. Play in browser lets you try it first; Install puts it on your ZakkyBoy.

**One game at a time.** Installing a new game replaces the one already on it, and you can switch back whenever you like. Want two on one install? Use **Zakky Pixel + Zakky Gun**: on its menu, tap the button for Zakky Pixel or hold it for Zakky Gun.

**Updating a game.** Games get better over time. To get the latest version, just install it again from the games page.

## The games

| GAME | WHAT IT IS |
|---|---|
| 1 BUTTON · ZB-1 · GPIO20 | |
| Zakky Pixel | The first ZakkyBoy game: a one-button helicopter. |
| Zakky Gun | One-button arcade shooter. |
| Zakky Pixel + Zakky Gun | Both on one install. Tap for Zakky Pixel, hold for Zakky Gun. |
| Gravity Tunnel | One-button tunnel game. Zakky Gun grew out of it. |
| 2 BUTTONS · ZB-2 · GPIO20 AND GPIO3 | |
| Zakky Dungeon | Card dungeon: fight monsters, drink potions and pick up weapons from a deck. |
| Zakky Drift | Drift racer. One button steers left, the other right. |
| 6 BUTTONS | |
| Blocks | Falling blocks, played upright. Needs an SH1106 screen. |
| 7 BUTTONS | |
| Jake's Quest | Roguelike: move, shoot and bomb your way through. |

New games appear on the same page as they're finished, so check back now and then.

## If something goes wrong

| PROBLEM | TRY THIS |
|---|---|
| No Install button, or it says the browser isn't supported | Open the page in Chrome or Edge on a computer. |
| The pop-up list is empty | Try a different USB-C cable (some only charge) or another USB port. Still nothing? Hold the **BOOT** button on the little board, plug the cable in while holding it, let go, then click Install again. |
| It stops partway with an error | Unplug, plug back in and try again. If it keeps failing, do the BOOT trick above and tick "erase" this time. |
| It installed but the screen stays blank | Press reset, or unplug and plug back in. If it's still blank, tell Zak. |
| The game runs but the buttons do nothing | Your buttons are wired to different pins from the ones the game expects. Tell Zak which pins they're on and he'll make a version for them. |

## Doing it by hand

Only needed if the games page ever doesn't work.

1. On the games page, open the game and click **.bin** to download it (for example `zakky-pixel.bin`).
2. In Chrome or Edge, go to `espressif.github.io/esptool-js`.
3. Click **Connect** and choose your ZakkyBoy.
4. Set **Flash Address** to `0x0`, choose the `.bin` file and click **Program**.
5. When it finishes, press reset or unplug the ZakkyBoy.

> **Why .bin and not .ino?** An `.ino` file is a game's source code, the version people read and edit. Before it can run on the ZakkyBoy it has to be turned into a `.bin` file, which is what you install. That's already been done for every game on the page.

## More on the website

### Guide

Make your own ZakkyBoy game with AI, from the first prototype to flashing it.

### Community

Games made by other ZakkyBoy owners. Submit yours to get it on there.

### Got an idea?

Suggest a game or hardware idea, report a bug or book a repair.